MIL-T-36616A
4 December 1978
SUPERSEDING
MIL-T-36616
19 November 1969, and
AMENDMENT 4
20 June 1977

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

# TUBING, SURGICAL, PLASTIC, 3/16 INCH INSIDE DIAMETER

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

## 1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers plastic, conductive surgical suction tubing suitable for suction in surgical procedures in hazardous locations and which may be used with oxygen or gas anesthetics.

1.2 Classification. The tubing shall be of the following types and classes, as specified (see 6.1):

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Type I. | - | 6 feet |
| Type II. | - | 12 feet |
| Type III. | - | 100 feet |
| Class A. | - | Sterile |
| Class B. | - | Non-sterile |

## 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bid or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Defense Personnel Support Center, Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 6515

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-585 - Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

MILITARY

MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof, or Waterproof, Flexible.
MIL-S-36586 - Sterilization Test Strip Set, Bacterial Spore.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications, standards, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bid or request for proposal shall apply.

U. S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

Pharmacopeia of the United States (USP)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

ASTM D 412 - Rubber Properties in Tension, Tests for.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101.)



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UNDERWRITERS' LABORATORIES, INC. (UL)

UL 1067 - Electrically Conductive Equipment and Materials for Use in Flammable Anesthetizing Locations.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc., 207 East Ohio Street, Chicago, IL 60611, 333 Pfingsten Road, Northbrook, IL 60062, 1285 Walt Whitman Road, Melville, LI, NY 11746, 1655 Scott Blvd., Santa Clara, CA 95050.)

U. S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION, AND WELFARE, FOOD AND DRUG ADMINISTRATION (FDA)

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Food and Drug Administration, Washington, DC 20204.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 Tubing. Tubing shall be flexible polyvinyl chloride (PVC) meeting the USP Class IV plastic requirements, as specified in 4.4.3.

3.1.2 Conductive line. The conductive line shall be vinyl and carbon black mixture.

3.2 Style, design and dimensions. The PVC tube shall be transparent, flexible, and conductive, and shall not collapse under a 22-inch mercury vacuum, as specified in 4.4.1.3. Type III tubing shall have an integral connector (bubble) at nominal intervals of 36 inches. Types I and II have end connectors and no intermediate bubbles. The tubing shall be 3/16 inch inside diameter (ID) or .188 inch $\pm$ .010 inch ID and have a minimum wall thickness of .036 inch. The bubble for type III tubing shall be .375 inch $\pm$ .031 inch ID with a wall thickness of .060 inch minimum. The bubble shall be capable of being cut to form a funnel connector to tubing having a 7/32 inch to 5/16 inch outside diameter (OD). The ID of the funnel connector shall be 7/32 to 3/8 inch. An alternate design for types I and II tubes shall have a female connector permanently bonded to each end and a separate male connector supplied with each tube.



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3.2.1 Conductive line. The conductive line shall be an integral stripe for the entire length of the tubing and for the entire wall thickness. The minimum width of this stripe shall be 1/32 inch.

3.3 Physical properties.

3.3.1 Tensile strength. The unaged tensile strength shall be 1,000 pounds per square inch (psi) minimum. Retention of tensile strength shall be a minimum of 60%, when tested after performing oven-aging, as specified in 4.4.2.3.

3.3.2 Elongation. The elongation shall be 100% minimum, when tested as specified in 4.4.1.2. Retention of elongation shall be a minimum of 60%, when tested after performing oven-aging, as specified in 4.4.2.3.

3.3.3 Fire and casualty hazards. The contractor shall submit proof, prior to delivery, that the tubing to be delivered under the contract conforms to the applicable requirements of the UL Standard of Safety for conductivity. Proof shall consist of one of the following:

a. UL label affixed to the product, provided the contractor agrees to have Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc. forward a copy of the UL report directly to the Contracting Officer, or the Government Inspector, upon request.

b. Laboratory report from a nationally recognized independent laboratory. If an independent laboratory is used, it must be adequately equipped and competent to determine compliance with UL standards. The Government reserves the right to require a facilities report and to conduct a facilities survey. Any laboratory report submitted shall include actual test methods, data taken, and results of tests. Detailed findings of examinations necessary to determine compliance shall also be included. The test report shall also have a section that describes the test sample in such a way that the report can be used to insure identity of production items with the test sample. This section shall be supplemented with construction information such as materials used, spacings between electrical components, types of bushings, photographs, wiring diagrams, sketches, and parts list, all appropriately identified. Compliance with this paragraph does not excuse compliance with all other requirements of the contract and specifications.

3.4 Electrical properties.

3.4.1 Electrical resistance. The electrical resistance shall be 40,000 ohms maximum after 48 hours or more, after extrusion for a 5-foot length of tubing, when tested as specified in 4.4.2.1.



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3.5 Oxygen or gas anesthetics. The tubing shall show no deterioration, when used with oxygen or gas anesthetic. When tested as specified in 4.4.2.2, tubing shall show no deterioration nor any increase in resistance of more then 100%, after exposure to the ethyl ether vapor.

3.6 Autoclaving. When tested as specified in 4.4.4, class B tubing shall not become distorted or cracked, nor shall it become adversely affected so as to impair its use.

3.7 Sterility. The class A tubing shall be sterile, when tested with a biological indicator, as specified in 4.4.5.

3.7.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that samples from each sterilizer lot have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include.

a. Item identification.
b. National Stock Number (NSN).
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number.
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Quantity of product in sterilizer lot.
g. Type of sterilization (gas, radiation, heat, steam, etc.).
h. Form of biological indicator (i.e., inoculated paper spore strip or carrier, inoculated product, or inoculated simulated product).
i. Test organism(s) and population density used.
j. Test medium, incubation temperature, incubation time, and dates of tests.
k. Number of test units.
l. Statement that samples comply with sterility tests.
m. Signature of head of a laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.

When inspection is made at destination, the certificate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the Defense Personnel Support Center, Directorate of Medical Materiel, Technical Operations Division, ATTN: DPSC-ATQ, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, and a copy forwarded with each shipment to the consignee. When inspection is made at source, certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant Government Quality Assurance Representative for submission to the procuring activity.



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3.7.2 Sterility lot. A sterility lot is that single quantity of product subjected to the same manufacturing operation and sterilized simultaneously in the same sterilizer chamber. Each unit package shall be clearly marked with a sterility lot (control) number and date of sterilization as specified in 5.3.1. Each sterility lot shall be traceable to the pertinent manufacturing lot(s).

3.8 Caution marking. Tubing shall be marked approximately every 12 inches with the words: "Not to be filled with liquid ethyl ether".

3.9 Instructions. Instructions shall be provided with each unit coil or length for forming funnel and tapered connector ends.

3.10 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Tubing shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual and auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one 100-foot, 12-foot or 6-foot coil, length depending upon type and class.



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TABLE I. Sampling for examination.

| Type defect | Inspection level | AQL (percent defective) |
|---|---|---|
| Major | S-3 | 2.5 |
| Minor | S-2 | 2.5 |

4.2.2 Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table II. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one 100-foot, 12-foot or 6-foot coil, length depending upon type and class. Where feasible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

TABLE II. Sampling for tests.

| Characteristic | Requirement | Test procedure | Inspection level | AQL (percent defective) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Vacuum | 3.2 | 4.4.1.3 | S-1 | 1.5 |
| Dimensions | 3.2 | - | S-1 | 6.5 |
| Tensile strength | 3.3.1 | 4.4.1.1 | S-2 | 1.0 |
| Elongation | 3.3.2 | 4.4.1.2 | S-2 | 1.0 |
| Conductivity | 3.4.1 | 4.4.2.1 | S-2 | 1.0 |
| Resistance to oxygen or anesthesia | 3.5 | 4.4.2.2 | S-1 | 1.5 |
| Autoclaving (class B) | 3.6 | 4.4.4 | S-2 | 1.0 |
| Sterility (class A) | 3.7 | 4.4.5 | S-3 | 1/ |

1/ Acceptance number shall be zero.

4.3 Examination. The tubing shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in tables I and III. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in table III. Any tubing in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected and, if the number of defective tubings in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by that sample shall be rejected.



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TABLE III. Classification of defects.

| Categories | Defects |
|---|---|
| Major | |
| 101 | Surface is tacky. |
| 102 | Tubing is kinked to point of interfering with fluid flow. |
| 103 | Presence of foreign matter in fluid path. |
| 104 | Tubing lacks caution marking. |
| Minor | |
| 201 | Presence of foreign matter on exterior of tubing. |
| 202 | Tubing is not transparent at other than conductive line. |

4.3.1 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the packaging, packing, and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Physical properties test.

4.4.1.1 Tensile strength. The tensile strength shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D 412.

4.4.1.2 Elongation. The elongation shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D 412.

4.4.1.3 Resistance to vacuum. A six-foot length of the tubing shall be subjected to a 22-inch mercury vacuum for three minutes.

4.4.2 Electrical properties test.

4.4.2.1 Electrical resistance tests. The tubing shall be tested in accordance with the UL Standard for Anesthesia Equipment and equipment to be used in Class I, Group C hazardous atmospheres. This method consists of using 5-foot lengths of tubing fitted at the ends with copper tubing in contact with the inside surface of the PVC tubing for a depth of 1/2 inch. Measurements shall be made with a suitably calibrated ohmmeter, which shall operate on a nominal open-circuit output voltage of 500 volts DC and a short-circuit current of 5 milliamperes with an effective internal resistance of 100,000 ohms $\pm$ 10%.



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4.4.2.2 Ethyl ether vapor test. Eight-inch lengths of the PVC tubing shall be exposed to ethyl ether vapor at room temperature (68° to 72°F) (20° to 22.2°C) for a 24-hour period. The electrical resistance of the samples shall be measured as described in 4.4.2.1, initially and 24 hours after the exposure.

4.4.2.3 Oven-aging. Eight-inch lengths of tubing shall be subjected to oven-aging for 1 week (168 hours) at a temperature of 212°F (100°C). Electrical resistance shall be measured as described in 4.4.2.1, before and after the samples have been subjected to oven-aging. The samples shall be held at room temperature for 6 hours before testing for electrical resistance.

4.4.3 Biological test. The PVC tubing shall be tested in accordance with the requirements for Class IV plastics as stated in the USP.

4.4.4 Autoclaving. Tubing shall be steam-autoclaved for 20 minutes at 250°F (121.1°C) and 15 pounds per square inch gage and then allowed to cool to room temperature (68° to 72°F) (20° to 22.2°C).

4.4.5 Sterility test. The class A tubing shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the USP for non-parenteral devices using inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). Product containing a biological indicator shall be marked or labeled so that it clearly differentiates from product intended for distribution. The incubation medium and minimum time in each case shall be soybean casein digest for 7 days for inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). The incubation temperature shall be as indicated in 4.4.5.1. The minimum number of test units, regardless of lot size, shall be 10, except for inoculated carrier which shall be 20 for type I sterilization and 30 for type II sterilization including inoculated carrier and product test units. The inspection level shall be as indicated in table II.

4.4.5.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. For each type of sterilization, the organism used shall be as listed below:

| Type of Sterilization | Organism | Incubation Temperature |
|---|---|---|
| Steam | B. stearothermophilus | 55° - 65°C |
| Dry Heat | B. stearothermophilus or | 55° - 65°C |
| | B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii) | 30° - 35°C |
| Gas | B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii) | 30° - 35°C |
| Radiation | B. pumilus | 30° - 35°C |

The number of viable cells shall be sufficient to provide assurance that the product has been sterilized.



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4.4.5.2 Inoculated carrier. Inoculated carriers (paper spore strips) if used, shall be in accordance with MIL-S-36586. Other paper carriers shall be inoculated to be of equivalent resistance. The method of incubation and number of test units shall be as indicated in 4.4.5 and 4.4.5.1. The method of sterilization will control the organism in the spore strip to be tested for as shown in 4.4.5.1.

When an inoculated carrier is chosen, product samples must also be tested as required by the USP.

4.4.5.3 Alternate method. Suppliers conducting sterility tests or designating lots in a manner other than that indicated herein shall submit proof that the alternate method provides equal assurance concerning the sterility of the product. However, all sterility tests shall be conducted using biological indicators. Requests for approval of any alternate method of testing for sterility shall be made to the Contracting Officer, and approval obtained before employment of the alternate method on a government contract.

4.4.5.4 Product testing. Testing for sterility of the product after receipt by the Government shall be without a biological indicator and in accordance with the USP.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One coil containing 100 feet of type III, class B or one package containing 50 individually packaged lengths of type I, class A or one package containing 20 individually packaged lengths of type II, class A, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1.1 Individual package. (Type I, class A or type II, class A.) Each length of tubing shall be wound into a coil of suitable size to prevent kinking or damage to tubing. Coil of tubing shall be packaged in a sealed peel-open type bag capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless one bag is damaged or opened.

5.1.1.1.2 Unit package. Each coil of type III, class B or 50 individual packages of type I, class A or 20 individual packages of type II, class A shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure of box shall be in accordance with the appendix of the box specification.



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5.1.1.2 Level C. Tubing shall be packaged in a manner that will afford adequate protection against deterioration and physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Ten units of issue of type III, class B or four units of issue of type I, class A or type II, class A shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grade V3c. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.1.1 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Fiberboard box shall be waterproof as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Ten units of issue of type III, class B or four units of issue of type I, class A or type II, class A shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The packaged tubing shall be packed in shipping containers in a manner that will afford adequate protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. These packs shall conform to the applicable carrier's rules and regulations.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Individual package. Types I and II, class A marking shall meet the requirements of the Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. Marking shall include the legend "STERILE-STERILITY GUARANTEED UNLESS PACKAGE IS DAMAGED OR OPENED", or similar statement.

5.3.2 Unit package and exterior container. Each unit package and exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. For types I and II, class A, marking shall include the lot (control) number. In addition, the method of sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, C-Cold, S-Steam, D-Dry Heat Sterilization) shall be shown following the level of packaging and the date of packaging. Example: "A-9/77-G". Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date.



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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
c. Type and class required (see 1.2).

6.2 NSN coverage. This specification covers the following items appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

| NSN | Item Identification |
|---|---|
| 6515-00-935-5837 | TUBING, SURGICAL, Plastic, 3/16 Inch Inside Diameter, 100 Feet Long, Non-sterile. |
| 6515-01-035-4413 | TUBING, SURGICAL, Plastic, 3/16 Inch Inside Diameter, 6 Feet Long, Sterile, 50s. |
| 6515-01-035-4414 | TUBING, SURGICAL, Plastic, 3/16 Inch Inside Diameter, 12 Feet Long, Sterile, 20s. |

6.3 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
DLA-DM

Project No. 6515-2075

Review activity:
DOD-MB



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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER *(Number)* AND TITLE

MIL-T-36616A TUBING, SURGICAL, PLASTIC, 3/16 INCH INSIDE DIAMETER

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS OF SUBMITTER

☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER

1. ☐ *HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT* USE? ☐ IS ANY PART OF IT TOO RIGID, RESTRICTIVE, LOOSE OR AMBIGUOUS? PLEASE EXPLAIN BELOW.

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING

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C. REASON FOR RECOMMENDED CHANGE(S)

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